ETHICS AND AI

Activity 1 Report

Analyzing AI-Generated Content on a Real-World Problem

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Subject	Ethics and AI

1. Introduction

Problem Selected:

Drafting a Policy on AI Use in Education — This problem was selected because the rapid integration of AI tools in academic environments raises urgent questions about fairness, academic integrity, student privacy, and equitable access.

AI Tool Used:

Claude (by Anthropic) — a large language model AI assistant capable of generating detailed, contextual responses to complex prompts.

Objective of the Activity:

The objective of this activity is to interact with a Generative AI tool using at least five meaningful prompts related to the selected problem, record the full conversation log, critically evaluate the AI's responses for accuracy, completeness, fairness, and potential bias, and reflect on the ethical implications of relying on AI for important decision-making tasks in education.

2. Conversation Log

The following five prompts were submitted to Claude (by Anthropic) along with the corresponding AI-generated responses.

Prompt 1: What are the key principles that should guide an AI use policy in higher education institutions?

AI Response: A comprehensive AI use policy in higher education should be built around five core principles: (1) Academic Integrity — clearly defining what constitutes misuse of AI (e.g., submitting AI-generated work as one's own without disclosure); (2) Transparency — requiring students and faculty to disclose when AI tools are used in academic work; (3) Equity and Access — ensuring all students have fair access to approved AI tools regardless of economic background; (4) Privacy and Data Security — governing how student data is handled by third-party AI platforms; and (5) Critical Thinking — designing AI use so it augments rather than replaces student reasoning and learning. These principles should form the backbone of any institutional policy.

Prompt 2: How should universities address academic dishonesty when students use AI to complete assignments?

AI Response: Universities should adopt a tiered approach rather than blanket bans. First, clearly distinguish between prohibited use (submitting AI output as original work) and permitted use (using AI for brainstorming or grammar checks). Second, update academic integrity codes explicitly to cover AI misuse. Third, invest in AI detection tools while acknowledging their limitations and potential for false positives. Fourth, redesign assessments to be AI-resistant — prioritizing oral exams, in-class writing, and reflective portfolios over take-home essays. Fifth, educate students about responsible AI use rather than simply punishing violations. A culture of integrity is more effective than policing alone.

Prompt 3: What ethical guidelines should govern the use of AI surveillance tools in educational settings?

AI Response: AI surveillance in education — such as proctoring software or attendance monitoring — must be governed by strict ethical guidelines: (1) Informed Consent: students must be clearly informed about what data is collected and how it is used; (2) Proportionality: surveillance should be limited to contexts where it is strictly necessary and not extended to personal spaces; (3) Non-Discrimination: AI tools must be tested for racial, gender, and disability bias — existing studies show some proctoring tools disproportionately flag students of color; (4) Data Minimization: only necessary data should be collected, stored for the minimum required duration, and never sold to third parties; (5) Right to Appeal: students must have a clear mechanism to contest decisions made based on AI surveillance outputs.

Prompt 4: How can AI tools be used responsibly by students in research without compromising originality?

AI Response: Students can use AI responsibly in research by following these practices: (1) Use AI for literature mapping and identifying research gaps, but read and verify every source independently; (2) Use AI to outline or brainstorm arguments, but write all final text independently; (3) Disclose all AI assistance in the methodology or acknowledgments section; (4) Avoid using AI to generate data, statistics, or citations — fabricated references are a serious academic integrity violation; (5) Critically evaluate every AI output — AI tools can hallucinate facts and miss nuance. The student's own intellectual contribution must remain the core of any research work.

Prompt 5: What are the long-term risks of students depending heavily on AI for academic work?

AI Response: Heavy dependence on AI for academic work poses several long-term risks: (1) Erosion of Critical Thinking — if students outsource analysis to AI, they may not develop the cognitive skills essential for professional careers; (2) Skill Atrophy — writing, problem-solving, and research skills may deteriorate with disuse; (3) Overconfidence in AI Output — students may uncritically accept AI-generated misinformation; (4) Widening Inequality — students with better AI tools or prompt skills may gain unfair advantages; (5) Ethical Drift — normalized AI use without reflection can create a generation comfortable with intellectual shortcuts. Education systems must actively build AI-critical literacy alongside AI fluency to mitigate these risks.

3. Critique of AI Output

Criterion	Evaluation	Details
Accuracy	High	Responses were factually sound and aligned with established academic litera
Completeness	Mostly Complete	Covered major dimensions well; however, responses lacked region-specific le
Potential Bias	Low-Moderate	Responses were generally balanced. Slight Western-centric bias observed —
Reliability	Good	No factual hallucinations detected. All cited principles are verifiable, though n
Clarity	Excellent	Structured, numbered responses made outputs easy to read and evaluate.

Overall, the AI-generated responses demonstrated a high level of quality for a generative tool. The outputs were well-structured and informative. The main limitations were the absence of jurisdiction-specific legal frameworks and academic citations, both of which are important for institutional policy drafting.

4. Ethical Reflection

Strengths of Generative AI

Generative AI tools like Claude demonstrated impressive ability to synthesize complex, multi-dimensional topics quickly. They are accessible 24/7, can provide structured and readable outputs, and help students explore perspectives they may not have initially considered. For drafting policy frameworks, AI provides a strong starting point that human experts can then refine.

Limitations of AI Responses

Despite their strengths, AI responses lack real-time knowledge, cannot cite primary academic sources reliably, and may miss local legal or cultural context. AI systems are trained on historical data, which can embed systemic biases. The responses in this activity, while accurate, did not account for the specific challenges faced by educational institutions in India or other non-Western contexts.

Risks of Depending on AI Decisions

Relying on AI for consequential decisions — such as framing institutional policies or academic integrity judgments — carries significant risks. AI can produce plausible-sounding but incorrect information. Policymakers and educators who accept AI outputs without critical verification may inadvertently institutionalize flawed or biased frameworks. Furthermore, opaque AI decision-making reduces accountability.

Need for Human Oversight

Human oversight is essential at every stage of AI-assisted decision-making. In education especially, the values of critical thinking, fairness, and intellectual growth cannot be outsourced to algorithms. Educators and policymakers must act as informed validators of AI outputs rather than passive consumers. Establishing clear review mechanisms, ethical boards, and regular audits of AI tools used in education is not optional — it is a prerequisite for responsible adoption.

This activity highlighted both the promise and the peril of generative AI in academic contexts. AI tools can accelerate thinking and broaden perspectives, but they must be used as a starting point for human critical reasoning — not as a substitute for it. Responsible AI use in education requires transparency, critical evaluation, and unwavering human judgment.